

RACHEL YOUNGHYUN KIM

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Social Science Researcher | Behavioral Insights, Ethical AI & Psychology | Humanitarian Technology

Researcher and analyst with a background spanning cognitive science and social science. Research interests center on empathy, prosocial behavior, social cooperation, and social cognition, with a growing focus on how AI can be designed and deployed to address human behavioral barriers in humanitarian, public health, education, and social impact contexts. Experienced in mixed-methods research, program evaluation, audience-centered communications and website design, and building AI-assisted tools and workflows for non-technical teams.

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

June 2025

Master of Social Science (M.S.S.) — GPA: 4.0 | Social Sciences Departmental Award

Relevant Coursework: Quantitative Data Analysis in Social Science, Qualitative Social Science Research Methods, Social Science Research and Perspectives

University of Southern California (USC)

May 2022

Bachelor of Arts, Cognitive Science — Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 3.97 | USC Summer Undergraduate Research Fund (2021)

Relevant Coursework: Social Cognition, Cognitive Processes, Behavioral Neuroscience, Abnormal Psychology, Developmental Psychology, Sensation and Perception, Origins of the Mind, Origins and Evolution of Human Behavior, Philosophy of Mind, Design for User Experience

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Made New Foundation

July 2025 – Present

Research and Evaluation Manager — Los Angeles, CA

Re-entry and justice-reform nonprofit serving youth, incarcerated, and formerly incarcerated individuals through VR-based programming

- Built the organization's first formal research and evaluation infrastructure from the ground up — developing survey and observation protocols, scoring guides, data management systems, theories of change, logic models, and an outcome indicator library adapted from 9 validated psychometric tools across youth, prison, and re-entry programs
- Conducted mixed-methods data collection across all programs, including participant interviews, classroom and program observations, and survey administration, translating findings into internal reports, funder-facing communications, school district presentations, and program recommendations that informed curriculum adjustments and participant incentive planning
- Designed a reusable Claude-powered reporting workflow that converts summarized program data into structured first-draft evaluation reports, enabling a non-technical nonprofit team to translate survey findings into clear insights, recommendations, and partner-facing language
- Built participant tracking templates in Google Sheets and automated pre/post evaluation templates in Excel with formulas for domain means, effect sizes, and pre/post change scores from Qualtrics survey data; trained 10 facilitators on survey administration and observation protocols
- Directed website strategy, information architecture, and content design (madenewfoundation.org) to serve multiple stakeholder audiences — schools, funders, and community partners; conducted usability testing across devices with internal and external testers and used Squarespace analytics (75% direct traffic, ~35% mobile visits over a 30-day period) to inform ongoing design and content decisions
- Expanded organizational capacity through branding, event coordination, social media content, donor pitch materials, and testimonial video production

Two Hearts One Mission

April 2026 – Present

Digital Communications Strategist — Contract — Los Angeles, CA

Newly founded Los Angeles-based re-entry nonprofit, 501(c)(3)

- Independently designed, built, and deployed the organization's website (twoheartsonemission.org) from the ground up, including site architecture, branding, and content strategy, under a \$500/month retainer covering website and social media management
- Conducted informal usability testing across devices with internal team members and outside testers, iterating design based on feedback; prioritized mobile-first design decisions, later validated by analytics showing approximately 83% of visits arriving via mobile devices
- Manage ongoing social media content and organizational communication materials — brochures, flyers, digital assets — translating the organization's mission into accessible messaging for donors, community members, and system-impacted individuals and families
- Monitor Squarespace analytics to inform content and design decisions; traced a measurable single-day traffic spike to a specific launch-announcement social media post, and identified that roughly two-thirds of visits arrive via direct return traffic

Girls Inc. of Los Angeles

December 2024 – June 2025

Graduate Research Intern — Los Angeles, CA

- Evaluated a newly implemented Bold Unit curriculum by aligning academic literature, organizational theory of change, classroom implementation, and stakeholder priorities into a coherent assessment framework

- Designed qualitative protocols, conducted classroom observations and student interviews, and synthesized findings into data visualizations, presentations, and actionable recommendations for program leadership

UCLA Master of Social Science Program

October 2024 – June 2025

Program Administrative Assistant — Los Angeles, CA

- Compiled a database of 30+ Student Affairs Officers to support program recruitment and outreach efforts
- Managed student lounge operations, inventory, and outreach material distribution; supported program workshops and liaised between students and the Program Director

USC Viterbi School of Engineering

January 2022 – May 2022

Teaching Assistant for ITP 310: User Experience Design — Los Angeles, CA

- Designed and led hands-on workshops teaching wireframing methodology for an undergraduate UX design course focused on mobile application design, providing in-class facilitation and individualized student guidance
- Reviewed, critiqued, and graded student wireframing projects for mobile applications, offering constructive written feedback on design decisions and UX principles
- Managed course administration through Blackboard, including grade tracking, feedback distribution, and student communications
- Maintained consistent communication between students and the course professor via email and in-person support

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

USC Social Learning and Choice Lab

August 2020 – August 2024

Undergraduate Research Assistant — Los Angeles, CA

PI: Leor Hackel, PhD

- Investigated how wealth and generosity interact to shape one's ability to attract social capital in conditions of economic inequality, contributing to an ongoing Public Goods Game study on the social and cognitive motivations underlying cooperation
- Designed and implemented a real-time, multiplayer cooperative economic game end-to-end using Python and HTML/CSS on the oTree platform — providing hands-on experience building tools to study prosocial behavior and decision-making under uncertainty
- Conducted data analysis using R and contributed to manuscript preparation; recruited and facilitated 100+ participants via MTurk and Sona
- Led a targeted literature search on social influences on cooperation to develop the theoretical introduction for an upcoming publication; authored a comprehensive process documentation guide enabling future research assistants to replicate the full experimental workflow
- Received USC Summer Undergraduate Research Fund (2021)

USC Mind and Society Center: Culture and Self Lab

October 2022 – August 2024

Undergraduate Research Assistant — Los Angeles, CA

PI: Daphna Oyserman, PhD | Advisor: Amabel Jeon, MA, PhD

- Conducted two literature reviews examining how cultural identity and fluency shape information processing: (1) collectivism's effect on processing ambiguous information; (2) carry-over effects of cultural (dis)fluency on downstream cognition
- Assisted with IRB proposal development for a new study; piloted and cleaned Qualtrics survey data in preparation for analysis

USC Brain and Creativity Institute: Brain and Music Lab

February 2020 – August 2021

Undergraduate Research Assistant — Los Angeles, CA

PI: Assal Habibi, PhD

- Investigated the impact of music listening and playing on brain development in children, with a focus on cognitive outcomes; supervised behavioral testing for local elementary school children to ensure data reliability
- Managed data collection, entry, and organization across Qualtrics and Redcap platforms

Inner Octaves Project

May 2020 – September 2020

Research Intern — Los Angeles, CA

Advisor: Tara Rose, PhD

- Designed and conducted 15 virtual interviews with allied health professionals to produce an educational video on the underutilized role of music therapy in supporting older adults' mental health
- Examined the intersection of COVID-19, social justice movements, and mental health, exploring music therapy as a behavioral and psychological intervention

USC Leonard Davis School of Gerontology: Emotion and Cognition Lab

January 2019 – May 2019

Undergraduate Research Assistant — Los Angeles, CA

PI: Mara Mather, PhD

- Recruited 50+ participants and facilitated group sessions for a study on heart rate variability and stress response; logged and managed data using Qualtrics and Excel

PROJECTS

Prism: AI-Powered Behavioral Analysis Tool (2026)

Designed and built a public-facing, Claude-powered behavioral analysis tool that surfaces the empathic, cooperative, and cognitive dynamics driving human behavior in real-world social scenarios. Users submit a policy, program, or social problem; Prism draws from behavioral science, cognitive science, social psychology, and social science to analyze what is happening, why it persists, and what evidence-based levers could move the needle. Built with HTML, JavaScript, and the Anthropic API; deployed to GitHub Pages with a secure Vercel serverless proxy.

Enhancing Global Crisis Communication via Generative AI Chatbots (2024 – 2025)

Graduate capstone examining how generative AI chatbots can improve humanitarian crisis communication by delivering personalized, context-sensitive guidance during moments of uncertainty. Analyzed cognitive barriers (information overload, mistrust, risk interpretation differences) and argued for an AI communication framework that adapts public-facing messaging to different audiences without sacrificing accuracy or ethical responsibility.

Claude-Assisted Evaluation Reporting Workflow (2025 – 2026)

Designed a reusable AI-assisted workflow for nonprofit program evaluation: a structured prompt template that generates first-draft evaluation reports from pre/post program data, paired with an Excel template computing domain means, Cohen's d, and effect size interpretations across psychometric domains. Deployed at Made New Foundation to help a non-technical team produce research-quality outputs at scale.

SKILLS

AI & Technology: Claude, Anthropic API, Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Workflow Development, AI Use-Case Scoping, Vercel Serverless Functions, GitHub, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Python, oTree

Research: Mixed-Methods Research, Survey Design, Field Observation, Qualitative & Quantitative Analysis, Pre/Post Analysis, Reporting, Data Visualization, Interviewing

Digital & UX-Adjacent: Website Strategy & Information Architecture, Audience-Centered Content Design, Informal Usability Testing, Squarespace Analytics, Wireframing (instructional)

Software: R, Qualtrics, Excel, MTurk, RedCap, Squarespace, Canva, Figma, HTML/CSS, oTree, PowerPoint, Zotero, SONA, DNS/Domain Management, GoDaddy, Bluehost, Monday, Slack

Languages: Korean (Native)

CERTIFICATIONS

AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations, Anthropic — 2026

Claude 101, Anthropic — 2026

GCP: Social and Behavioral Research Best Practices for Clinical Research, CITI Program (ID: 47764724) — 2022

Social-Behavioral Human Subjects Research, CITI Program (ID: 47764723) — 2022

HONORS & AWARDS

Social Sciences Departmental Award, UCLA — 2024

Latin Honors: Summa Cum Laude, USC — 2022

Dean's List, USC Dornsife College of Letters, Arts and Sciences — 2019 – 2021

Summer Undergraduate Research Fund, USC — 2021

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

USC Science Outreach

August 2019 – December 2021

Science Educator

- Designed and instructed weekly hands-on STEM lessons for elementary school students (grades 1–2); managed 10+ lesson plans per semester; facilitated remote learning during the pandemic

USC Wrigley Institute for Environmental Sustainability

August 2019 – May 2021

Social Outreach & Media Chair, Wrigley Ambassadors

- Organized on-campus sustainability events, planned field trips, and led social media content creation to promote environmental engagement within the USC student community